Sunny Liang Tan (谭靓)

CURRICULUM VITAE

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) | Ph.D. in Economics — Oct 2021 - Jun 2027 (expected)
Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) | Visiting Scholar — Sep 2024 - May 2025
Duke University | M.A. in Economics — Sep 2019 - May 2021
The University of Hong Kong | B.A. in Economics & Finance; Minor in Mathematics — Sep 2015 - May 2019

RESEARCH FIELDS

Fields: Macroeconomics, Development Economics, International Trade

Focus: Industrial Policy, Innovation Policy, Production Networks

JOB MARKET PAPER

Propagation of Industrial Policy Along Supply Chains: Evidence from Government Venture Capital in China

Using Chinese VAT administrative data and VC/PE records, I construct firm-level investment and transaction measures and apply a matched staggered difference-in-differences design to identify the causal effects of government industrial guidance funds on productive efficiency, capital allocation, labor demand, and sales growth, as well as upstream and downstream spillovers. The funds target innovative firms, whose expansion subsequently promotes growth and innovation among downstream firms. I further incorporate innovation into a Baqaee-Farhi production-network model and quantify the aggregate output gains from government venture capital investment. The results provide an economic rationale for industrial policy in the presence of induced learning along production networks.

OTHER RESEARCH

Exchange-Rate Movements and U.S. Corporations

with Ivo Welch and Yuqing Zhou | Submitted

Use U.S. Census LFTTD microdata and shift-share instruments to estimate the effects of exchange-rate exposure and the associated elasticities for exports, sales, and equity returns. The study provides firm-level micro evidence showing that the apparent macro-level exchange rate-stock market disconnect does not hold.

Coordination in Production Networks

Work in progress

Use Chinese VAT administrative data to study complementarities when upstream and downstream firms receive investment simultaneously. Examine how information frictions, financing constraints, and decentralized decision-making generate under-coordination, and whether government coordination and policy intervention can internalize production-network complementarities.

Are Banks Discriminatory? Evidence from U.S. Residential Lending

with Jon Vogel | Work in progress

Merge court-order data with bank Call Reports to construct a matched panel of more than two million observations; use a difference-in-differences (DiD) design to identify the causal effects of judicial interventions on lending behavior and bank credit-supply elasticity.

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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) | Research Assistant to David Autor
"New Frontiers: The Origins and Content of New Work: 1940-2018" | Quarterly Journal of Economics (QJE)

- Developed OCR and NLP pipelines to digitize historical occupational records and construct occupational-content variables and labeled datasets for a task model.
- Implemented an instrumental-variables (IV) strategy to estimate the effect of new work on wage inequality.

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) | Research Assistant to Jon Vogel
"The Race Between Education, Technology, and the Minimum Wage" | Quarterly Journal of Economics (QJE)

- Characterized analytical solutions to a job ladder model and derived monotonicity properties of equilibrium allocations.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) | Teaching Assistant, Advanced Microeconomics
University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) | Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. International Macroeconomics
Duke University | Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Econometrics

PRESENTATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Presentation: West Coast Micro-to-Macro Development Workshop, 2026.
- Presentation: MIT Trade Lunch, 2025.
- Organizing Committee, Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics, 2023.
- Initiator, UCLA Women in Economics, 2023-2025.

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

SoftBank China Venture Capital | Research Analyst — Jan 2026 - May 2026
China Artificial Intelligence and Energy

- Conducted market and company research in the AI and energy sectors, evaluated business models and competitive positioning, and supported comparable-company analysis, financial modeling, and investment due diligence.

Muxin Asset Management (Shanghai) | Quantitative Research Intern — Dec 2016 - Jan 2017
A-Share Alpha Strategies / Foreign Exchange Research

Bank of China (Hong Kong) | Summer Analyst — Jun 2017 - Jul 2017
Bond Connect Due Diligence / Regulatory Materials

PROGRAMING AND LANGUAGES

Programing: Python, R, Stata, MATLAB

Languages: Mandarin (native); English (fluent); Cantonese and Spanish (conversational)